

Boehringer Ingelheim — AI Immersion Day Discovery Brief

Research date: June 16, 2026. Fast-changing facts (leadership, financials, regulation, pipeline) must be re-verified live before facilitation.

TL;DR

- **BI walks in strong but squeezed:** €27.8bn FY2025 net sales (+7.3% currency-adjusted), 22.9% of sales into R&D, two landmark 2025 launches and positive survodutide obesity data in 2026 — yet Jardiance alone is ~€8.8bn (≈32% of group sales) and is hitting loss-of-exclusivity plus US Medicare price negotiation, forcing speed and execution to become existential.
- **The “feel it in the room” pressure is the collision of scale, re-shoring and regulation:** a \$20bn US build-out (2025–2030) under a tariff-linked deal, a 54,000+ workforce with a ~2,000-person “hire-to-retire” Global Business Services machine across four hubs, all operating inside German co-determination and squarely under the EU AI Act’s high-risk employment rules that go live 2 August 2026 — exactly when immersion-day ideas would reach production.
- **The sharpest framing question:** not “where could AI help BI” but “where is BI already under enough operational and regulatory pressure — patent cliff, US footprint build-out, a unionized German core and a global people machine — that leaders will feel the pain immediately?”

Position

Boehringer Ingelheim enters an AI Immersion Day from genuine strength that is being squeezed from several directions at once. It is the world’s largest privately held pharmaceutical company — family-owned since 1885, €27.8bn in 2025 group net sales (up 7.3% currency-adjusted), and one of the industry’s heaviest R&D investors at 22.9% of sales (€6.4bn). It just delivered two landmark launches (zongertinib/Hernexeos in HER2-mutant lung cancer; nerandomilast/Jascayd, the first new IPF therapy in over a decade), and its obesity/MASH candidate survodutide is reading out positive Phase III data through 2026. But the same things that make BI strong also concentrate its risk: Jardiance (€8.8bn, ≈32% of group sales) is approaching loss-of-exclusivity and was selected for US Medicare price negotiation; a \$20bn US re-shoring plan tied to a December 2025 tariff deal must be executed under cost pressure; and the regulatory perimeter around execution — EU AI Act high-risk employment rules from August 2026, German co-determination, FDA AI guidance, GMP Annex 1 — is hardening just as BI digitizes. The most useful question for the room is therefore not “where could AI help BI” but: **where is BI already under enough operational and regulatory pressure — patent cliff, US footprint build-out, a hire-to-retire HR machine spanning 54,000+ people and a unionized German core — that leaders will feel the pain in the room immediately?**

Boehringer Ingelheim snapshot

Boehringer Ingelheim is a research-driven biopharmaceutical group headquartered in Ingelheim am Rhein, Germany, founded in 1885 and family-owned ever since by the Boehringer and von Baumbach families (company materials also reference the Liebrecht family). The group operates in three business areas: Human Pharma (the dominant unit), Animal Health (one of the world’s largest), and Biopharmaceutical Contract Manufacturing (BioXcellence). It serves over 130 markets and reached 70 million patients in 2025, up from 66 million in 2024 (BI press release, 25 Mar 2026).

A note on headcount that matters for the room: BI’s own communications disagree. The German/global corporate version of the 2025-results release states “approximately 54,300 employees serve over 130 markets,” while the US version of the same release (25 Mar 2026) and the Global Top Employer 2026 materials say “approximately 54,500

employees.” The ~54,300 vs ~54,500 discrepancy is therefore an artifact of BI’s own DE-vs-US versions of the same announcement; treat as ~54,000+ and validate live.

The legal apex is C. H. Boehringer Sohn AG & Co. KG, the parent holding entity, with Boehringer Ingelheim International GmbH as a principal operating company; Boehringer AG acts as general partner of the KG (confirmed via a 2023 SEC Schedule 13D filing). Governance is split between a Shareholders’ Committee (chaired by Hubertus von Baumbach from 1 July 2025, succeeding Christian Boehringer) and a Board of Managing Directors (chaired by Shashank Deshpande from 1 July 2025). The owners have publicly considered and ruled out an IPO.

The company’s strategic spine in 2025–2026 is a wave of pipeline launches plus a re-shoring of investment toward its core markets — most prominently a \$20bn US investment plan (2025–2030) tied to a December 2025 agreement with the US administration that secured a Section 232 tariff exclusion. Germany remains the largest production and R&D base (~40% of global R&D spend, nearly 50% of 2025 investment), even as the company expands in the US, Greece, and Japan.

Key Findings

- **Financial strength, concentrated risk.** Human Pharma is €22.7bn of €27.8bn group sales; within it, Jardiance (€8.8bn) and Ofev (€3.8bn) dominate. R&D intensity is high (Human Pharma R&D alone is 27.4% of unit sales). The pipeline (>80 projects, >50 NMEs) is the hedge against the Jardiance cliff.
- **Two 2025 launches landed; survodutide is the 2026 story.** Hernexeos (FDA accelerated approval 8 Aug 2025, expanded to first-line) and Jascayd (IPF 7 Oct 2025; PPF 19 Dec 2025) are commercial. Survodutide hit 16.6% weight loss in SYNCHRONIZE-1 (28 Apr 2026), with full SYNCHRONIZE-1/MASLD data at ADA (7 Jun 2026) published in NEJM and Nature Medicine; MASH Phase III (LIVERAGE) ongoing.
- **Leadership is freshly reshuffled** (chairmen changed 1 Jul 2025; new IT & GBS board division 1 Feb 2026), which itself is a transformation signal.
- **HR is a strength AND a regulated exposure.** A sixth-year Global Top Employer brand, a ~2,000-person GBS running hire-to-retire across Manila/Buenos Aires/Germany/Wroclaw, and a Data Science Academy (3,000+ upskilled; 10,000+ on Dataland) — all inside German co-determination and the EU AI Act high-risk employment perimeter.
- **AI is already operational in discovery and data** (IBM, OpenProtein.AI, Tempus, Google Quantum, AWS Dataland, a new UK AI Accelerator), making governance the binding constraint, not capability.

Details — “Metric / Latest public read”

A. Legal, ownership & governance

Metric	Value	Source	Date / as-at	Confidence
Top holding entity	C. H. Boehringer Sohn AG & Co. KG	SEC Schedule 13D; corporate materials	2023 / current	Confirmed
Operating entity	Boehringer Ingelheim International GmbH (“wholly owned indirect subsidiary of Parent”)	SEC Schedule 13D	June 2023	Confirmed
General partner of the KG	Boehringer AG	SEC Schedule 13D	June 2023	Confirmed
Owning families	Boehringer / von Baumbach (also Liebrecht)	corporate materials / Wikipedia	current	Reported
Governance split	Shareholders’ Committee vs Board of Managing Directors	BI leadership pages	current	Confirmed

Metric	Value	Source	Date / as-at	Confidence
Shareholders' Committee Chair	Hubertus von Baumbach (from 1 Jul 2025; succeeded Christian Boehringer, Chair since 2007)	BI press release	17 Apr 2025	Confirmed
IPO stance	Considered and ruled out	Wikipedia / corporate history	current	Reported
Number of family shareholders	Not found in public sources	—	—	Open question

B. Financials

Metric	Value	Source	Date / as-at	Confidence
FY2025 group net sales	€27.8bn (\$31.4bn), +7.3% currency-adjusted	BI press release "Reports 2025 Growth"	25 Mar 2026	Confirmed
FY2024 group net sales	€26,796m (+6.1%)	BI 2024 results / annual report facts & figures	2 Apr 2025	Confirmed
FY2025 Human Pharma sales	€22.7bn (\$25.6bn), +7.4%	BI press release	25 Mar 2026	Confirmed
FY2025 Animal Health sales	€4.9bn (\$5.5bn), +6.5%	BI press release	25 Mar 2026	Confirmed
FY2024 Human Pharma / Animal Health	€21,928m / €4,749m	BI 2024 annual report facts & figures	2024 FY	Confirmed
FY2025 R&D spend	€6.4bn (\$7.2bn), 22.9% of net sales	BI press release	25 Mar 2026	Confirmed
FY2024 R&D spend	€6.2bn, 23.2% of net sales	BI 2024 results	2 Apr 2025	Confirmed
Human Pharma R&D (2025)	€5.8bn (\$6.6bn), 27.4% of unit sales	BI press release	25 Mar 2026	Confirmed
BioXcellence (CMO) FY sales	Not separately disclosed in 2025 release	—	—	Open question
Operating income / income after taxes	Not found in FY2025 press release	—	—	Open question
Capital expenditure (FY2025 group)	Not separately disclosed in FY2025 release (US investment plan: \$1bn capex through 2028)	BI press release	19 Dec 2025	Open question / partial
FY2025 annual results publication	Released 25 Mar 2026	BI newsroom	25 Mar 2026	Confirmed
2026 interim update	Not yet published as of research date	—	—	Validate-live

C. Footprint & operating model

Metric	Value	Source	Date / as-at	Confidence
Employees	~54,500 (US release / Top Employer 2026); ~54,300 (DE corporate release) — same 2025-results announcement, different versions	BI press releases	2026	Confirmed (DE vs US)
Markets served	Over 130 markets	BI press releases	2026	Confirmed
Three business areas	Human Pharma; Animal Health; Biopharmaceutical Contract Manufacturing (BioXcellence)	BI corporate pages	current	Confirmed

Metric	Value	Source	Date / as-at	Confidence
Largest R&D site	Biberach, Germany (>7,600 employees; largest R&D center; also largest EU biopharma manufacturing site)	BI site page	current	Confirmed
HQ / largest site	Ingelheim (>10,200 employees; production & launch)	BI US site page	current	Confirmed
US footprint	>9,000 employees across all 50 states	BI US “Who we are”	current	Confirmed
Key sites	Ingelheim, Biberach, Vienna, Ridgefield CT, Athens/Duluth GA, Lyon, Shanghai, Sant Cugat, Koropi, Yamagata, Dortmund, Kobe, Fornovo, Xochimilco	BI “Where to find us”	current	Confirmed
Number of affiliates	~145–181 cited in third-party profiles (varies); not a current BI-published figure	trade profiles	varies	Inferred / Validate-live
Number of production / R&D sites	Not found as a single current BI-published figure	—	—	Open question

D. Pipeline & commercial position

Metric	Value	Source	Date / as-at	Confidence
Jardiance FY2025 sales	€8.8bn (\$9.9bn), +8.7%	BI press release	25 Mar 2026	Confirmed
Ofev FY2025 sales	€3.8bn (\$4.3bn), +5.4%	BI press release	25 Mar 2026	Confirmed
NexGard FY2025 sales	€1.4bn (\$1.6bn), +8.5% (top-selling parasiticide brand)	BI press release	25 Mar 2026	Confirmed
Zongertinib (Hernexeos)	FDA accelerated approval, pretreated HER2-mutant non-squamous NSCLC	FDA	8 Aug 2025	Confirmed
Zongertinib first-line	FDA accelerated approval, treatment-naïve (ORR 76%, N=72)	BI / FDA	2025–26	Confirmed
Nerandomilast (Jascayd) IPF	FDA approval (US & China), idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis; first new IPF therapy in >10 years	BI / Pulmonary Fibrosis Foundation	7 Oct 2025	Confirmed
Nerandomilast (Jascayd) PPF	FDA approval, progressive pulmonary fibrosis	FDA / PFF	19 Dec 2025	Confirmed
Survodutide SYNCHRONIZE-1 (obesity)	16.6% mean weight loss at 76 wks vs 3.2% placebo (p<0.0001)	BI press release	28 Apr 2026	Confirmed
Survodutide ADA full data	SYNCHRONIZE-1 + SYNCHRONIZE-MASLD presented; published in NEJM + Nature Medicine; 63% liver-fat / 34% visceral-fat reduction	BI / ADA 2026	7 Jun 2026	Confirmed
Survodutide MASH	LIVERAGE & LIVERAGE-Cirrhosis Phase III ongoing	BI press release	2026	Confirmed
Survodutide origin	Licensed from Zealand Pharma; BI solely responsible for development/commercialization	Zealand Pharma JPM deck	Jan 2026	Confirmed
Pipeline size	>80 projects, >50 new molecular entities	BI press release	25 Mar 2026	Confirmed
Jardiance LoE	US compound exclusivity lapsed ~Feb 2025; selected for Medicare price negotiation (prices effective 2026); generic launch estimates vary widely	trade / Pharmacy Times / Pharsight	2025–26	Reported / Validate-live

E. Leadership — Board of Managing Directors & Shareholders' Committee

Role	Holder	Source	Effective	Confidence
Chairman, Board of Managing Directors (+ Human Pharma)	Shashank Deshpande	BI press release	1 Jul 2025	Confirmed
Vice Chairman, Group Functions / "Chief Human Resources Officer"	Michael Schmelmer	BI press release; Global Top Employer 2026	Vice Chair from 1 May 2024	Confirmed
Innovation Unit	Dr Paola Casarosa	BI leadership page	current	Confirmed
Animal Health	Dr Armin Wiesler	BI leadership page	current	Confirmed
Finance	Frank Hübler	BI press release	from 1 May 2024	Confirmed
IT & Global Business Services (new Board Division)	Harsha Deshmukh (ex-Infinion CIO)	BI press release	1 Feb 2026	Confirmed
Shareholders' Committee Chair	Hubertus von Baumbach	BI press release	1 Jul 2025	Confirmed
Functional/operational Global Head of HR (below board)	Not publicly disclosed. Predecessor Dr Sven Sommerlatte vacated the global HR role ~mid-2025 (now President / Country Managing Director, Animal Health, BI USA)	LinkedIn (Sommerlatte profile + VMX 2026 activity); BI legacy pages	2025–26	Validate-live / Open question

F. HR / People-function context

Metric	Value	Source	Date / as-at	Confidence
HR operating model	HR Business Partners + Centres of Excellence + Global Business Services running "hire-to-retain"	BI careers; Francabandera XING/ LinkedIn profile	current	Confirmed
GBS scale	~2,000 people	BI careers (People, Finance & Organization)	current	Confirmed
GBS hub locations	Manila, Buenos Aires, Germany, Wrocław (plus sourcing teams worldwide)	BI careers	current	Confirmed
Global Top Employer	6th consecutive year (Global Top Employer 2026), well-being at core	BI press release	2026	Confirmed
Top Employer country count	Certified in 31 countries; listed among top employers 12 consecutive years	BI Global Top Employer 2026	2026	Confirmed
L&D structures	Functional-Specific Academies; Global Leadership Development Programs; BI University virtual campus	Francabandera profile; BI Top Employer 2026	current	Confirmed
Data Science Academy	Launched Oct 2021; 3,000+ employees upskilled	AWS case study	2023	Confirmed
Dataland reach	"Facilitated use of data for 10,000+ employees"; cut data access from months to hours	AWS case study	2023	Confirmed
Workforce metrics (gender, women in leadership %, training hours, attrition, apprentices, engagement)	Not found as current BI-published global figures	—	—	Open question

Metric	Value	Source	Date / as-at	Confidence
Works council / co-determination	German Betriebsrat / Mitbestimmung applies to BI's German core; not separately quantified publicly	German legal context (inferred)	current	Inferred

G. Enterprise AI / data & digital posture

Item	Status	Source	Date	Confidence
IBM antibody foundation models	Collaboration to use IBM biomedical foundation models for therapeutic-antibody discovery	IBM Newsroom	28 Nov 2023	Confirmed
OpenProtein.AI antibody discovery	Partnership signed 2025; expanded 2026 to co-develop antibody-specific workflows (PoET foundation models)	OpenProtein.AI / PRNewswire	31 Mar 2026	Confirmed
Tempus AI oncology	Multi-year strategic collaboration; access to Tempus de-identified data + Lens platform (8M+ records)	Tempus / BioSpace / BusinessWire	14 May 2025	Confirmed
Google Quantum AI	Quantum computing for R&D (molecular dynamics); initial 3-year partnership; dedicated Quantum Lab	BI; PharmaTimes; Fierce	Jan 2021	Confirmed
AWS "DataLand"	Company-wide data platform on AWS; data lake on Amazon S3; AWS Glue	AWS case study	2023	Confirmed
UK AI Accelerator	New AI Accelerator in UK's Knowledge Quarter	BI newsroom	20 Apr 2026	Confirmed
Corporate Data & AI initiative	Strategic corporate-wide Data & AI program (responsible AI, agentic ambitions), presented by Bhawna Paul	BI / conference keynote	2025–26	Reported
AI governance roles (Director AI Governance & Data Privacy Counsel; Global Head of Data Governance & Insights)	Not verified in public sources	—	—	Open question

H. Regulatory / risk perimeter

Item	Detail	Source	Date	Confidence
EU AI Act — high-risk employment (Annex III)	High-risk obligations enforceable 2 Aug 2026; employment/worker-management AI is Annex III; systems that profile persons are always high-risk	EU AI Act Art. 6(2)/ Annex III; Cloud Security Alliance & law-firm analyses	2026	Confirmed
EU AI Act penalties	Art. 99(4): up to €15,000,000 or 3% of total worldwide annual turnover, whichever is higher, for breaches of deployer obligations (Art. 26)	EU AI Act Article 99(4)	in force	Confirmed
EU AI Act possible delay	"Digital Omnibus" package, announced Feb 2026, proposes postponing Annex III high-risk obligations from Aug 2026 to Dec 2027 — not enacted (needs Parliament + Council); analysts advise "do not plan around it"	McKenna Consultants analysis	2026	Reported
FDA AI draft guidance	"Considerations for the Use of AI to Support Regulatory Decision-Making for Drug and Biological Products" — risk-based credibility/context-of-use framework	FDA / Foley, DLA Piper, Goodwin	6 Jan 2025	Confirmed
Senvelgo CVM warning letter	Animal Health USA warning letter (promotional misbranding vs boxed warning on DKA)	FDA CVM	1 Mar 2024	Confirmed

Item	Detail	Source	Date	Confidence
Senvelgo closeout	FDA closeout letter — violations addressed	FDA CVM	25 Sep 2024	Confirmed
Ben Venue / Xellia consent decree	Modified consent decree (original Ben Venue 2013) vacated by US court	FirstWord / Xellia	29 Apr 2024	Confirmed
GMP Annex 1 / DSCSA serialisation	Apply to sterile manufacturing and US supply-chain track-and-trace (raise cost of weak execution)	regulatory context	current	Inferred
GDPR / German co-determination	Apply to worker-data and HR-AI deployments	legal context	current	Inferred

I. Strategic “why now” signals

Signal	Detail	Source	Date	Confidence
US investment plan	~\$20bn across human + animal health in US, 2025–2030 (~2/3 R&D, ~1/3 manufacturing); \$10bn through 2028 incl. \$1bn dedicated capex	BI / PRNewswire; BI US “Who we are”	19 Dec 2025	Confirmed
US tariff deal	Broad agreement with US administration; Section 232 tariff exclusion; TrumpRx.gov participation; one of nine companies in the Dec 2025 tranche	BI / PRNewswire; DCAT	19 Dec 2025	Confirmed
Germany investment weighting	~€15bn in R&D+capex over past five years; ~40% of global R&D; ~50% of 2025 investment; Germany is ~5% of global Human Pharma sales (~€1.2bn)	BI “Planning certainty” article	2025	Confirmed
Greece (Koropi)	€120m expansion, +110 jobs, boosts Jardiance exports to US; only multinational innovative-medicine plant in Greece	European Pharmaceutical Review / CHEManager	Jan 2024	Confirmed
Japan (Yamagata)	~€300m (¥48.4bn) by 2028; designated regional Asia-Oceania hub; new building from Mar 2026	Taiwan Pharma Alliance / BI Japan	20 Jun 2025	Confirmed
Carbon neutrality	Carbon-neutral operations (Scope 1&2) by 2030; SBTi targets (Scope 1,2,3) validated 2023; internal carbon price €100/t; 19 sites certified carbon-neutral in 2025	BI sustainability / PRNewswire	2026	Confirmed

What this means (interpretation)

The pressure points are concentrated and mutually reinforcing:

- **Revenue concentration meets the patent cliff.** Jardiance alone is ~32% of group sales and faces eroding US exclusivity plus Medicare price negotiation. The launches of Hernexeos/Jascayd and the survodutide readouts are the company’s hedge — which makes speed of launch and commercial execution existential, not incremental.
- **The \$20bn US build-out is a transformation programme in disguise.** Re-shoring two-thirds into US R&D and one-third into manufacturing over five years is a massive operations, hiring, and quality-systems lift under a tariff-linked commitment — precisely the kind of large-scale change where AI either accelerates or exposes weak process.
- **The HR machine is both a strength and an exposure.** A 54,000+ workforce, a ~2,000-person GBS running hire-to-retire across four hubs, a sixth-year Global Top Employer brand, and a Data Science Academy that has already upskilled 3,000+ people — but operating in a German co-determination environment and squarely inside the EU AI Act’s high-risk employment perimeter that goes live 2 August 2026. That is the sharpest “feel it in the room” tension: BI already deploys AI at scale in discovery (IBM, OpenProtein.AI, Tempus, Google Quantum) and data (Dataland), and just stood up a new IT & GBS board division — yet any AI touching hiring, promotion, or worker management becomes high-risk regulated almost exactly as the immersion day’s ideas would reach production, with fines up to €15m or 3% of global turnover.

Rapid-build challenge candidates (13)

Original candidates, informed by the reference structure but re-authored to BI's evidenced reality and deliberately tool-agnostic. Each carries an **implementation status** line so the room never proposes rebuilding something BI already has. Operational baselines are not public — the figures below are public scale / regulatory anchors only.

Stream A — Hiring & Recruitment (Recruit-to-Onboard)

Card 01 — Critical launch roles are sourced too slowly to hit the launch window

Theme: Hiring & Recruitment / Launch & Scientific Talent

Challenge statement: *“When a launch or a new platform lands, we’re given a date, not a runway. The roles we need most — launch commercial, medical, oncology, computational science — are the hardest to fill, and by the time we’ve sourced and screened, the window has moved. We’re always recruiting against the clock, and the clock keeps speeding up.”*

Why now: Hernexeos (US Aug 2025) and Jascayd (approved Oct/Dec 2025) are launching now, and survodutide’s Phase III obesity readout (Apr 2026) points to a category-defining launch. The \$20bn US build adds sustained demand. Launch peak-share is won or lost in the first months — exactly when hard-to-fill roles are still open.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- Two live launches (Hernexeos, Jascayd) + one late-stage obesity asset (survodutide, ~16.6% mean weight loss, Ph III)
- \$20bn US investment plan 2025–2030 (sustained hiring demand)
- R&D €6.4bn / 22.9% of sales — a deep, specialist hiring base
- Operational baseline not public: time-to-fill, req volumes, offer-accept, cost-per-hire — validate live
- **Implementation status:** no public evidence BI runs an AI recruiter copilot for launch hiring — confirm in discovery

Audience fit: Head of Talent Acquisition (launch & scientific); HRBP Human Pharma; TA Operations Lead

Cross-functional hooks: Launch Excellence Lead; Medical Affairs; Innovation Unit; Employer Brand; AI Governance Counsel

Card 02 — The AI & computational-science pipeline can't keep pace with BI's own AI strategy

Theme: Hiring & Recruitment / Scientific & AI Talent

Challenge statement: *"We've committed to AI and quantum at the bench, but we hire the people who make that real in the same market as every tech company. We can't always see who's out there, we move slower than the offers they get elsewhere, and we lose them on speed and story."*

Why now: BI's confirmed partnerships create direct, ongoing demand for exactly this talent — and the pool is small, global and tech-comp-anchored. The strategy is committed; the staffing has to follow.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- Confirmed AI partners: IBM (2023), OpenProtein.AI (2025/26), Tempus AI (2025), Google Quantum AI (2021)
- Dedicated Quantum Lab with specialist hiring; new UK AI Accelerator (Apr 2026)
- AWS Dataland reached 10,000+ employees (scale of the data community)
- Operational baseline not public: open-req counts / fill rates for AI roles — validate live
- **Implementation status:** no public evidence of a talent-intelligence capability for AI roles at BI — confirm in discovery

Audience fit: Head of TA for R&D / Tech; Talent Intelligence Lead; Reward Lead (comp competitiveness)

Cross-functional hooks: Innovation Unit; Head of Data Governance & Insights; IT & GBS; University Relations

Card 03 — The candidate experience for hard-to-fill roles is inconsistent and slow to respond

Theme: Hiring & Recruitment / Candidate Experience

Challenge statement: *"The people we most want to hire judge us on how it feels to apply. Right now they wait too long for a reply, get generic updates, and go cold while we're still coordinating internally. For a Top Employer, the gap between our brand and our funnel stings."*

Why now: BI's Top Employer positioning (31 countries) raises the cost of a weak funnel exactly as hiring volume spikes for the launches and the US build. Candidate experience becomes a retention-of-pipeline lever, not just a courtesy.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- Certified Top Employer in 31 countries; Global Top Employer (6th consecutive year)
- 130+ markets — candidate comms must be multilingual and on-brand
- Operational baseline not public: candidate-response times, NPS, funnel drop-off — validate live
- **Implementation status:** no public evidence of a candidate-experience assistant at BI — confirm in discovery

Audience fit: Head of Candidate Experience / Employer Brand; TA Operations

Cross-functional hooks: Brand / Communications; HR@GBS; Data Privacy / AI Governance Counsel

Card 04 — Hiring and talent-decision AI must be provably fair, transparent and human-overseen

Theme: Hiring & Recruitment / Responsible AI Governance

Challenge statement: *“Anything we build that touches who gets hired, promoted or moved is high-risk by law — and high-stakes for trust. We can’t bolt governance on afterwards, but we also can’t let ‘it might be risky’ freeze every useful tool. We need a way to deploy AI in talent decisions we can stand behind to a regulator, a works council and a candidate.”*

Why now: EU AI Act Annex III makes recruitment and worker-management AI high-risk; obligations apply from 2 Aug 2026, with fines up to €15m or 3% of global turnover. German co-determination adds a works-council dimension. This is buildable now and underpins every other Stream A candidate.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- EU AI Act (Reg. 2024/1689) Annex III — employment / worker-management = high-risk; obligations from 2 Aug 2026
- Penalties up to €15,000,000 or 3% of worldwide annual turnover (Art. 99(4))
- German Betriebsrat co-determination + GDPR Art. 22 constraints
- Operational baseline not public: BI’s current HR-AI inventory and works-council agreements — validate live
- **Implementation status:** no public evidence of an HR-specific AI assurance layer — likely a real gap given the Aug 2026 deadline

Audience fit: CHRO office + AI Governance / Data Privacy Counsel; People Analytics; Employee Relations / Co-determination Lead

Cross-functional hooks: Legal & Compliance; IT & GBS; Data Governance; Works Council liaison

Stream B — Talent Development (Learn-to-Grow / Develop-to-Perform)

Card 05 — Launch readiness depends on capability we must build faster than we can hire

Theme: Talent Development / Launch Readiness

Challenge statement: *“A launch lives or dies on whether the field, medical and access teams are ready on day one. Building that readiness the old way — classroom, slides, slow content — can’t keep up with the launch calendar, and every market needs it slightly differently. We’re always one cycle behind the launch we’re training for.”*

Why now: Live launches (Hernexeos, Jascayd) and a probable obesity/MASH launch (survodutide) create back-to-back readiness demand across markets. The gap is not ‘do we have academies’ — it’s whether content can be generated and localised at launch speed.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- Two live launches + survodutide late-stage; multi-market rollout
- Existing Functional-Specific Academies and Global Leadership Development Programs
- Operational baseline not public: completion, time-to-competency, field-readiness scores — validate live
- **Implementation status:** academies exist; no public evidence of AI-accelerated, launch-speed content generation/localisation — that speed is the gap

Audience fit: Head of Commercial / Medical Learning; Launch Excellence Lead; COE Learning

Cross-functional hooks: Medical Affairs (MLR sign-off); Market access; Local affiliate L&D; Regulatory

Card 06 — AI fluency is proven in the data community but uneven across the wider workforce

Theme: Talent Development / Enterprise AI Fluency

Challenge statement: *"We proved we can upskill at scale with data — thousands of colleagues came through the academy. But AI fluency can't stop at the data community. Scientists, manufacturing, commercial and HR ourselves all need to use these tools well and responsibly, and right now beyond the data roles it's patchy and self-taught."*

Why now: Confirmed AI partnerships and everyday GenAI make fluency operational, and the EU AI Act adds a responsible-use and AI-literacy imperative. The Data Science Academy is the proof the model works — the open question is breadth, not feasibility.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- Data Science Academy: 3,000+ upskilled; 10,000+ employees on Dataland
- Confirmed AI/quantum partnerships driving everyday tool exposure
- EU AI Act AI-literacy expectations
- Operational baseline not public: enterprise AI-fluency coverage by function — validate live
- **Implementation status:** Data Science Academy already covers data roles — do not rebuild it; the gap is responsible-GenAI fluency for non-data functions

Audience fit: Head of Capability / L&D; COE Learning (Chief Learning Officer if confirmed)

Cross-functional hooks: IT & GBS; Data Governance; AI Governance Counsel; function heads as sponsors

Card 07 — We can't see the skills we already have, so we over-hire and under-deploy

Theme: Talent Development / Skills Intelligence

Challenge statement: *"When a new priority lands, our first instinct is to hire — because we genuinely can't see who inside already has the adjacent skills. People who could grow into launch or AI-critical roles stay invisible, and we pay twice: external hiring cost, and disengaged internal talent who weren't asked."*

Why now: Simultaneous launch + AI + US-build demand makes internal redeployment economically essential. Without a skills view, the default is always external hiring — the slowest, costliest option for scarce roles.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- ~54,000+ employees across 130+ markets — a large latent skills base
- COE owns talent & succession and people development (natural home)
- Growth-engine roles (launch, AI, manufacturing) all need adjacent skills
- Operational baseline not public: internal-fill rate, skills coverage, mobility rate — validate live
- **Implementation status:** no public evidence of an enterprise skills graph at BI — confirm in discovery

Audience fit: Head of Talent Management / Strategic Workforce Planning; People Analytics

Cross-functional hooks: HRBP community; IT & GBS; Data Privacy (employee-data sensitivity); function heads

Card 08 — Internal mobility is too slow to feed launch and AI-critical roles

Theme: Talent Development / Internal Mobility

Challenge statement: *"We say 'build, borrow, buy' — but borrowing internally is the part that doesn't flow. Open critical roles and willing internal movers don't find each other fast enough, managers hold on to talent, and the marketplace we want stays theoretical. So we default back to external hiring even when the person is already on our payroll."*

Why now: The cost and speed pressure of launch/US-build hiring makes internal mobility the cheapest, fastest lever — if the matching works. It depends on the skills view from Card 07.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- Growth-engine demand (launch, AI, manufacturing) is public and concurrent
- COE talent-management remit covers mobility
- Operational baseline not public: internal-mobility rate, time-to-deploy — validate live
- **Implementation status:** no public evidence of an internal talent marketplace at BI — confirm in discovery

Audience fit: Head of Internal Mobility / Talent Marketplace; HRBP community

Cross-functional hooks: Strategic Workforce Planning; line managers; Reward; Works Council liaison

Card 09 — The US manufacturing build needs GMP & Annex-1 capability faster than the labour market supplies it

Theme: Talent Development / Manufacturing Capability

Challenge statement: *"We're committing billions to US manufacturing, but the people who can run modern sterile and biologics operations to current standards are scarce and slow to develop. We can pour concrete faster than we can build the qualified, GMP-ready workforce to fill the building."*

Why now: The \$20bn US plan includes manufacturing capex, and EU GMP Annex 1 (in force Aug 2023) raises the capability bar globally. Qualified operators and QA staff must be ready as capacity comes online — qualification can't be rushed.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- \$20bn US plan 2025–2030 (manufacturing capex component)
- EU GMP Annex 1 contamination-control expectations
- Global manufacturing & biologics (BioXcellence) network
- Operational baseline not public: site headcount, qualification timelines, competency gaps — validate live
- **Implementation status:** general manufacturing training exists; no public evidence of AI-accelerated qualification for the new US build — confirm scope

Audience fit: Head of Manufacturing / Operations L&D; Site HR; Quality Training Lead

Cross-functional hooks: Operations / Product Supply; Quality; Regulatory; IT & GBS

Stream C — HR Shared Services / GBS (Hire-to-Retire / Case-to-Resolution)

Card 10 — Employees and managers in 130+ markets wait too long for routine HR answers

Theme: HR Shared Services / Employee & Manager Self-Service

Challenge statement: *“Most of what people ask us, we’ve answered a thousand times — leave, pay, policy, ‘where do I go for X’. But it arrives in a dozen languages across a dozen time zones, and it sits in a queue. People lose time, our agents drown in repeat tickets, and the simple stuff crowds out the cases that actually need a human.”*

Why now: GBS already runs hire-to-retain from four hubs, and the Feb 2026 IT/GBS board seat sharpens the mandate to automate Tier-0. GenAI makes confident, source-grounded answers viable where legacy portals don’t.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- GBS: ~2,000 staff across 4 centres (Manila, Buenos Aires, Germany, Wroclaw) running ‘hire-to-retain’
- 130+ markets — multilingual, multi-policy demand
- Harsha Deshmukh — IT & GBS board responsibility from 1 Feb 2026
- Operational baseline not public: ticket volumes, deflection, handle times — validate live
- **Implementation status:** no public evidence of a Tier-0 HR knowledge assistant at BI — confirm whether any chatbot already exists

Audience fit: Head of HR Services / HR@GBS; GBS Service-Line Owner

Cross-functional hooks: IT & GBS (Deshmukh org); Data Privacy; COE Policy; local HR

Card 11 — Onboarding throughput buckles during hiring surges

Theme: HR Shared Services / Onboarding

Challenge statement: *“When hiring spikes for a launch or the US build, onboarding becomes the bottleneck — paperwork, provisioning, day-one readiness all pile up, and new joiners feel it in their first week. The very moments we most need people productive fast are the moments our process is most overloaded.”*

Why now: Launch hiring plus the \$20bn US build create exactly these surges. Onboarding spans HR, IT, facilities and compliance, so it’s the classic orchestration problem an agentic workflow can absorb without dropping steps.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- Concurrent launch hiring + multi-year US workforce build
- GBS hire-to-retain remit already includes onboarding process work
- Operational baseline not public: onboarding cycle time, surge volumes — validate live
- **Implementation status:** no public evidence of an onboarding orchestration copilot at BI — confirm in discovery

Audience fit: Head of Onboarding / HR Operations; GBS hire-to-retain Lead

Cross-functional hooks: IT provisioning; Facilities; Local HR; Hiring managers

Card 12 — Case triage and resolution eat agent time that should go to complex cases

Theme: HR Shared Services / Case Management

Challenge statement: *“Our agents spend their day reading long case threads, working out what’s actually being asked, finding the right policy and writing it up — before they even solve anything. The judgement cases, the sensitive ones, are where we add value, but they’re squeezed by the volume and the admin around every case.”*

Why now: GBS consolidation and the new IT/GBS board seat push for measurable service productivity. Summarisation, routing and drafting are now reliable enough to free agents for the sensitive cases that need a human.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- GBS scale: ~2,000 staff, 4 hubs, hire-to-retain case work
- New IT & GBS board ownership from Feb 2026 (productivity mandate)
- Operational baseline not public: case volumes, resolution times, reopen rates — validate live
- **Implementation status:** no public evidence of an HR case-resolution copilot at BI — confirm current case tooling in discovery

Audience fit: Head of HR Shared Services; Employee Relations (sensitive-case boundaries)

Cross-functional hooks: IT & GBS; Data Privacy; COE Policy; Legal & Compliance

Card 13 — Policy and compliance answers are hard to keep correct across 130+ markets

Theme: HR Shared Services / Policy & Compliance

Challenge statement: *“Every market has its own employment law, its own works-council reality, its own version of the policy. Keeping our guidance accurate everywhere — and giving managers a straight answer they can trust — is a constant chase. When the policy changes, we can’t be sure the answer people get the next day is the right one.”*

Why now: 130+ markets and German co-determination make manual upkeep fragile exactly as AI raises expectations for instant answers; EU AI Act and GDPR raise the bar on transparency and a wrong answer’s cost.

Baseline metrics / evidence:

- 130+ markets — heavy localisation
- German Betriebsrat co-determination + GDPR
- Operational baseline not public: policy-query volumes, answer-accuracy rates — validate live
- **Implementation status:** no public evidence of a governed policy-answer assistant at BI — confirm current knowledge-base approach

Audience fit: Head of HR Compliance / Employee Relations; COE Policy Owner

Cross-functional hooks: Legal & Compliance; local HR; Works Council liaison; IT & GBS

Out of scope for this audience

- **Predictive attrition / flight-risk modelling** — high value but sits with People Analytics and raises sensitive monitoring questions; cross-cutting, not a fast rapid-build.
- **Total Rewards / pay-equity optimisation** — specialist, data- and legally heavy; better as a dedicated stream.
- **Scientific / discovery AI itself (antibody design, quantum)** — owned by the Innovation Unit; HR’s role is the talent and fluency around it (candidates 02, 06).
- **Core HRIS / ATS / LMS platform replacement** — multi-year IT/GBS programme, not a rapid build.
- **Patient-facing or clinical AI** — regulated medical-device track; outside HR.

- **Works-council negotiation strategy** — a constraint on every candidate, but a legal/IR process, not an AI build.

Open questions to validate with the client

- **Who currently holds the functional Global Head of HR, Head of TA, and Head of L&D roles?** (Public sources name only the board-level Group Functions head.)
- **Post-Feb-2026, where does HR sit vs GBS?** What moves under the new IT & GBS board member, and what stays with the CHRO line?
- **HR technology estate** — HRIS, ATS, LMS, case-management/knowledge platform, people-analytics/skills tooling. None confirmed publicly.
- **HR operational baselines** (none public) — time-to-fill, req volumes, cost-per-hire, attrition, internal-mobility rate, ticket volumes/deflection/handle times, onboarding cycle time, learning completion.
- **Existing HR AI in use or pilot** (chatbots, screening, content generation) and current works-council agreements on HR AI, especially in Germany.
- **EU AI Act readiness for HR** — is there an inventory of HR AI use cases mapped to high-risk obligations, and who owns it?
- **Launch & US-build workforce plans** — target hiring volumes/roles (to size candidates 01, 05, 09, 11).
- **BioXcellence revenue, group operating income and capex** — not disclosed; needed to size the manufacturing-capability case.

Recommendations

- **Anchor the day on the patent-cliff clock.** Use Jardiance's ~32% revenue share and 2026 Medicare-negotiation timing as the "pain is now" frame; pressure-test AI use cases that compress launch and commercial timelines for Hernexeos, Jascayd, and a potential survodutide obesity launch. *Threshold that changes this:* if a survodutide obesity filing/approval timeline firms up, escalate it from pipeline to near-term commercial priority.
- **Treat the \$20bn US build-out as the flagship transformation canvas.** Map AI opportunities to the two-thirds R&D / one-third manufacturing split and the quality-systems load (GMP Annex 1, DSCSA, FDA AI guidance). *Threshold:* any change to the Section 232 exclusion or tariff terms re-prioritizes manufacturing localization.
- **Make EU AI Act readiness the HR through-line.** Frame people-function AI (talent acquisition, performance, workforce planning) against the 2 Aug 2026 high-risk obligations and German co-determination — design for human oversight, documentation, fundamental-rights impact assessment, and works-council engagement from day one. *Threshold:* if the Digital Omnibus delay to Dec 2027 is actually enacted, timelines loosen — but plan for August 2026 regardless.
- **Exploit the Data Science Academy / Dataland as proof the workforce can absorb AI.** 3,000+ upskilled and 10,000+ enabled on Dataland is a credible change-management base; pressure-test whether L&D structures (Functional Academies, BI University) can scale AI literacy into the GBS hubs and the new IT & GBS board division.
- **Close the open questions live.** Confirm the current functional Global Head of HR, BioXcellence revenue, group operating income, capex, and global workforce diversity/attrition metrics directly with BI before or during the session — these gaps are themselves findings, and they signal where the organisation's own data transparency is thinnest.

Caveats

- **Private company, limited disclosure.** BI does not publish the granular financials (operating income, segment-level CMO revenue, group capex) or workforce metrics a listed peer would; several cells are deliberately “not found in public sources / open question.” Gaps are findings, not failures of search.
- **The 54,300 vs 54,500 employee discrepancy is real and originates with BI itself** — the German corporate release says ~54,300, the US release of the same announcement says ~54,500. Treat as ~54,000+ and validate live.
- **HR leadership gap is unresolved.** Michael Schmelmer is the board-level CHRO / Group Functions head (Confirmed). The operational/functional Global Head of HR successor to Dr Sven Sommerlatte (who moved to President/Country MD, Animal Health BI USA ~mid-2025) is not publicly disclosed — do not assert a name in the room; BI does not publish functional/divisional heads, so absence of a named successor is expected, not evidence of a vacancy.
- **Affiliate / site counts** come from third-party profiles and vary (~145–181 affiliates); these are not current BI-published figures.
- **Several discovery-AI vendor and “responsible AI” governance claims** are confirmed only to the company-sourced or partner-sourced level noted; do not infer additional unconfirmed vendor relationships or named AI-governance roles.
- **The challenge candidates** use the reference card list as a structural prompt only — they are re-authored to evidenced BI realities, not copied.
- **Fast-changing facts** (leadership effective dates, FY figures, Jardiance patent/Medicare timing, EU AI Act delay status, survodutide regulatory milestones) must be re-verified at facilitation time (June 2026).